■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Sunday, September 06, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Pentagon has finally realized how easy it was for adversaries to hack deployed soldiers phone location data*

The Angle: *This is a national security story with a real 'wait, what?' factor - the Pentagon is only now catching up to a vulnerability that let adversaries potentially pinpoint deployed U.S. soldiers just from their phone's location data.*

- The **Pentagon** has acknowledged how easily **adversaries** could exploit **deployed soldiers'** phone location data.
- The concern centers on ordinary phone location tracking being usable to expose troop positions overseas.
- It raises the obvious follow-up: how long was this exposure happening before anyone caught it?

The Debate Starter

- If the Pentagon is just now realizing this, what does that say about how exposed the rest of us are every time we carry a phone?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.military.com/military-disabled-phone-trackers-on-troops-devices-lawmakers-say-not-enough?link_source=ta_first_comment&taid=6a9d329f44f9c40001adaf6f&utm_campaign=trueanthem&utm_medium=social&utm_source=facebook&fbclid=IwY2xjawUKURBwZG9mBWV4dG4DYWVtAjEwAGJyaWQRMW85Um1MQTkzYkxtanF0VHBzcnRjBmFwcF9pZBAyMjIwMzkxNzg4MjAwODkyAAEegm-CFSD7LG7ozgg_izwArUCJup3_SqVnJNATOjVzNam-VCTUD_RtixmtD_M_aem_9C67t_kB-gfAmaoE7GdrYw

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■ *Donna Mills, 85, reveals jaw-dropping workout regimen and surprising snack obsession*

The Angle: *Donna Mills, 85, reveals jaw-dropping workout regimen and surprising snack obsession*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://pagesix.com/2026/09/06/celebrity-news/donna-mills-85-reveals-jaw-dropping-workout-regimen-and-surprising-snack-obsession/

■ *Donna Mills, 85, reveals jaw-dropping workout regimen and surprising snack obsession https://t.co/oxLak0pfAn https://t.co/EyzXdi0Vic*

The Angle: *Donna Mills, the 'Knots Landing' icon, is turning heads by opening up about how she stays in shape at 85 — a feel-good aging-well story with a fun, relatable twist that always gets people talking about their own habits.*

- **Donna Mills**, 85, is opening up about her personal workout routine
- The 'Knots Landing' star also revealed a snack she's reportedly obsessed with
- Story is generating buzz online for how surprising her regimen reportedly is

The Debate Starter

- What's YOUR excuse — call in with the weirdest habit that actually keeps you feeling young.

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2096772985814175801

■ *In 2017, a 14-year-old Virginia girl dug a backyard pond for a school project; 9 years later, it has become a thriving wildlife ecosystem*

The Angle: *In 2017, a 14-year-old Virginia girl dug a backyard pond for a school project; 9 years later, it has become a thriving wildlife ecosystem*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/world/rest-of-world/in-2017-a-14-year-old-virginia-girl-dug-a-backyard-pond-for-a-school-project-9-years-later-it-has-become-a-thriving-wildlife-ecosystem/amp_articleshow/133834489.cms

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■ *US to announce sharply lower vehicle fuel economy requirements*

The Angle: *Washington's reportedly rolling back how fuel-efficient new cars have to be, which is a direct hit to every driver's wallet at the pump and a fresh front in the climate-vs-cost fight.*

The Debate Starter

- Do you actually care about your car's fuel economy, or is gas mileage the last thing on your mind when you buy?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reuters.com/world/us-announce-sharply-lower-vehicle-fuel-economy-requirements-2026-08-31/

Backup options:

■ *GPT-6 Astra beat Portal, and it only cost $571.18*

The Angle: *An AI model reportedly played through the classic video game Portal on its own — and the whole experiment cost less than $600, which is wild considering what AI compute usually runs. It's another marker of how fast AI is closing the gap on tasks that require actual reasoning and problem-solving, not just chat.*

- The AI system, referred to as **GPT-6 Astra**, completed the puzzle game **Portal** from start to finish
- The entire run cost roughly **$571.18** in compute
- Portal is known for physics-based puzzle logic, not just reflexes — a tougher test for AI than typical benchmarks

The Debate Starter

- If an AI can out-think a puzzle game for the price of a video game itself, what's actually left that's 'too hard' for AI?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/990897/gpt-6-astra-beat-portal-and-it-only-cost-571-18

■ *AI writing has already begun to appear on the opinion pages of the Wall Street Journal, the Washington Post, and the New York Times*

The Angle: *If AI writing can slip past editors at the **Wall Street Journal**, **Washington Post**, and **New York Times**, that's a trust problem for every reader — and a preview of a fight coming to every newsroom.*

- AI-generated writing has reportedly turned up in opinion sections at three of the most trusted names in American media: the **Wall Street Journal**, the **Washington Post**, and the **New York Times**
- These are opinion pages specifically — the section built on a named writer's own voice and judgment, which is exactly why AI slipping in there stings more
- It's reigniting the debate over whether newsrooms need mandatory AI-disclosure rules before this becomes the norm instead of the exception

The Debate Starter

- If you found out your favorite columnist used AI to write their last op-ed, would you trust them less?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.semafor.com/article/08/26/2026/ai-writing-has-already-begun-to-appear-on-oped-pages

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CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Treasury Secretary Compares Canada To 'Little Yippy Dog'*

The Angle: *A top US official taking a shot at Canada with a line this quotable is instant cross-border drama - it's the kind of insult that gets replayed on every newscast and lights up comment sections on both sides of the border.*

- The **US Treasury Secretary** reportedly compared **Canada** to a **"little yippy dog"**
- The comment is already circulating and drawing reaction on **r/canada**

The Debate Starter

- Funny jab or genuine disrespect - where's the line when a US official talks about Canada like that?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nz.news.yahoo.com/treasury-secretary-compares-canada-little-024503392.html

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■ *Two-tier health care underway in Alberta - Medicine Hat News*

The Angle: *Canada's whole identity is built on 'health care shouldn't cost you a cent' - so any move toward a two-tier system where money can buy faster access is going to touch a nerve nationwide, not just in Alberta.*

The Debate Starter

- If you could pay out of pocket to skip a months-long wait list for surgery, would you - or does that break the whole promise of Canadian health care?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://medicinehatnews.com/news/local-news/2026/09/05/two-tier-health-care-underway-in-alberta/

■■ *Concerns over flood-compromised roads remain in Cape Breton after torrential rain batters island*

The Angle: *Torrential rain hammered Cape Breton and now the cleanup headache is roads that just aren't safe yet - washouts and weak spots are the kind of thing that can strand a community fast, and it's a good check-in on how climate-driven storms keep hitting Atlantic Canada harder.*

The Check-In Question

- Anyone got family or friends out east dealing with washed-out roads right now?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/nova-scotia/concerns-over-flood-compromised-roads-cape-breton-9.7334486?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *B.C. drought forces volunteers to rescue salmon from drying streams*

The Angle: *B.C.'s drought has gotten so bad that everyday volunteers are wading into shrinking streams to physically move stranded salmon to deeper water - it's a wild visual, and scientists say it's a warning sign the situation is getting worse, not better.*

- **B.C.'s drought** has caused streams to dry up enough that fish are getting stranded and dying.
- **Volunteers** are wading into the water to physically relocate stranded **salmon and other fish** to deeper pools.
- **Scientists** warn the rescue efforts are becoming harder to sustain as waterways keep shrinking.
- **Extreme heat** is intensifying the problem, putting more pressure on already-low water levels.

The Watercooler Angle

- Would you volunteer to wade into a stream and hand-carry fish to save them - or is that a job for scientists, not citizens?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/science/bc-drought-rescuing-fish-drying-rivers-9.7330420?cmp=rss

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■ *Counter-tariffs won't just affect the cost of goods for Canadians. They'll hit the trailers moving them too*

The Angle: *Everyone expects grocery and household prices to jump under Canada's counter-tariffs on the U.S. — but the twist is the trucks hauling that stuff north are getting hit too, which could push shipping costs, and therefore prices, even higher.*

- Canadians are bracing for **billions of dollars** in counter-tariffs on American goods.
- Everyday items in the crosshairs: **produce, toilet paper, and furniture**.
- The twist: the **semi-trailers** used to haul those goods across the border are also getting tariffed.
- That means higher costs baked in before the product even hits the shelf.

The Debate Starter

- Is hitting back with counter-tariffs worth it if it just makes everything, including the delivery truck, more expensive for us too?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/trucking-semi-trailer-costs-us-tariffs-9.7330014?cmp=rss

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■ *How Prince Harry and Meghan's return to Britain is setting off 'shockwaves'*

The Angle: *Every time the Sussexes set foot back in Britain it turns into a tabloid frenzy, and this trip's being described as sending 'shockwaves' through the royal world — that's a big enough claim to make hosts ask what's actually got everyone spooked.*

The Debate Starter

- Are you still invested in Harry and Meghan drama, or are you fully checked out of royal news at this point?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/prince-harry-meghan-duchess-sussex-return-united-kingdom-canada-new-bill-king-charles-9.7332868?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Telluride's secret screening was revealed to be Nathan Fielder and Lance Oppenheim's Elizabeth Holmes doc "You Can See Everything." Watch th*

The Angle: *Telluride does a secret-screening stunt every year, and this one was worth the hype — Nathan Fielder teaming up with Lance Oppenheim for a documentary on disgraced Theranos founder Elizabeth Holmes, one of the most jaw-dropping fraud stories of the last decade.*

- The **Telluride Film Festival**'s secret screening slot was revealed to be a new documentary
- It's directed by **Nathan Fielder** and **Lance Oppenheim**
- The subject: disgraced **Theranos** founder **Elizabeth Holmes**
- It's titled **"You Can See Everything"** and already has a teaser trailer out

The Curiosity Hook

- Nathan Fielder doing anything is must-watch weird — pair him with the Elizabeth Holmes saga and this instantly jumps the must-see list.

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2096769947674578954

■ *Nathan Fielder Drops Weird Trailer for Secret Elizabeth Holmes Doc ‘You Can See Everything’ https://t.co/WlRmMx7pHJ*

The Angle: *Nathan Fielder does deadpan, awkward-cringe comedy — now he's apparently been quietly making a documentary about Theranos fraudster Elizabeth Holmes, and the trailer is reportedly as weird as you'd expect. That combo alone is a watercooler moment.*

- **Nathan Fielder** dropped a trailer for a previously secret documentary
- The film is titled **'You Can See Everything'**

- It centers on disgraced Theranos founder **Elizabeth Holmes**
- **Variety** broke the news of the trailer drop

The Debate Starter

- Is Nathan Fielder the right guy to tackle a story this dark, or does his comedy background make it feel off?

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2096768380074143926

■ *The quaalude comeback: a once 'extinct' drug from the 70s makes a resurgence*

The Angle: *It was the ultimate disco-era cautionary tale — banned, vilified, basically extinct for decades — and now it's reportedly resurfacing, which is exactly the kind of 'wait, what?' pop-culture headline that gets people talking.*

- **Quaaludes** were huge in the **1970s** party scene before being banned in the **US in 1984**
- The drug had been considered essentially **extinct** for a generation
- Reports now point to a **resurgence** of the once-banned sedative

The Throwback Debate

- Ask listeners: what's the wildest 'extinct' trend from your parents' era that's suddenly cool again?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/society/2026/sep/06/quaaludes-drug-comeback-popularity

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■ *Robert Pattinson Kisses Suki Waterhouse as 'Primetime' Rocks Venice With 7-Minute Standing Ovation*

The Angle: *Real-life couple Robert Pattinson and Suki Waterhouse turned the red carpet into the show, and the movie itself walked away with a seven-minute standing ovation - that's the kind of Venice buzz that turns into awards-season chatter.*

- **Robert Pattinson** was seen kissing longtime partner **Suki Waterhouse** on the red carpet at the Venice Film Festival
- The moment came at the premiere of his new film **"Primetime"**
- The film reportedly received a **7-minute standing ovation** from the Venice crowd

The Debate Starter

- Is a red-carpet PDA moment actually bigger water-cooler news than the movie that just got a 7-minute ovation?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/festivals/robert-pattinson-primetime-venice-premiere-1236837079/

Backup options:

■ *Lilly Wachowski Is "Kinda Done" With 'Matrix' Franchise As Drew Goddard Takes Over: "I Don't Wanna Play In That Sandbox Anymore"*

The Angle: *One of the original Matrix creators is publicly stepping away as a new director takes the reins — that's a rare, blunt admission from a franchise architect that always gets fans arguing about legacy versus reboot.*

- **Lilly Wachowski**, co-creator of **The Matrix**, says she's "kinda done" with the franchise.
- Her quote: "**I don't wanna play in that sandbox anymore**."
- **Drew Goddard** is reportedly taking over the franchise going forward.

The Debate Starter

- Should a franchise creator's exit be a red flag for fans, or is it just healthy to let someone new take the wheel?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/09/lilly-wachowski-kinda-done-matrix-franchise-1237069655/

■ *Mariska Hargitay Wins 2 Emmys For Her Documentary 'My Mom Jayne'*

The Angle: *Mariska Hargitay stepping out from behind the SVU badge to direct a deeply personal documentary about her late mother, Jayne Mansfield, and walking away with two Emmys for it — that's a real Hollywood full-circle moment worth talking about.*

- **Mariska Hargitay** won **two Emmys** for her documentary **'My Mom Jayne'**
- The film is a personal project — Hargitay both directs and explores her own family history through it
- Best known for two decades as Olivia Benson on **Law & Order: SVU**, this marks a big awards moment for her outside that role

The Debate Starter

- Which other actor should turn the camera on their own family story next?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/09/mariska-hargitay-primetime-emmy-wins-my-mom-jayne-1237069307/

■ *Susan Sarandon Says She's 'Still Had Movies Taken Away Recently' Over Palestine Support: 'There Are Agencies That Are Telling People Not to Hire Me'*

The Angle: *A two-time Oscar nominee saying agencies are actively steering work away from her over her politics is a live wire — it taps straight into the bigger fight over whether celebrities should face career consequences for their views on Israel-Palestine.*

- **Susan Sarandon** says she's "still had movies taken away recently" because of her support for Palestine
- Her claim: **"There are agencies that are telling people not to hire me"**
- Sarandon has been one of Hollywood's most vocal pro-Palestinian advocates, and has previously faced industry fallout over it

The Debate Starter

- Should an actor's politics ever be allowed to cost them a job — or is this just Hollywood playing it safe?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/festivals/susan-sarandon-movies-taken-away-palestine-support-1236853245/

■■ *Nicolas Cage Reacts To 'Spider-Noir' Cancellation*

The Angle: *Nicolas Cage doesn't usually weigh in on Hollywood's cancellation culture, so when he speaks up about losing 'Spider-Noir,' it's a rare peek behind the curtain — and a chance to talk about how even A-listers can't save a show these days.*

- **Nicolas Cage** was set to star in **'Spider-Noir**,' an animated series leaning into a moody, black-and-white take on the web-slinger.
- The project has reportedly been **cancelled**, and Cage is now publicly reacting to the news.
- It's the latest example of a starry passion project getting cut before ever really launching.

The Debate Starter

- Should a big name like Nic Cage attached to a show be enough to save it — or does even star power not matter to streamers anymore?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/09/nicolas-cage-reaction-spider-noir-cancellation-1237069665/

TRENDING TODAY

■■ *The datacenter backlash is bringing the entire political spectrum together – against big tech billionaires*

The Angle: *Data centers guzzling power and water for AI are turning into a rare bipartisan punching bag, with local communities from both red and blue areas pushing back on billionaire tech companies — a story that taps into shared frustration over energy bills, water use, and who's really benefiting from the AI boom.*

The Debate Starter

- When's the last time you saw the far left and far right actually agree on something — and does that make you trust this backlash more or less?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/ng-interactive/2026/aug/30/data-center-politics-democrats-republicans

Backup options:

■ *Study explores how an extreme male self-improvement trend known as looksmaxxing moved from obscure internet forums into mainstream public awareness. This relied not just on social media algorithms, but on a coordinated system of controversy, short-form video clips, and mainstream media coverage.*

The Angle: *A new study says this once-obscure, extreme male self-improvement trend didn't just go viral by accident — it was pushed into the mainstream through controversy, clips, and media coverage. It's a window into how fringe internet culture becomes everyone's problem.*

- **Looksmaxxing** is an extreme male self-improvement trend that started in obscure corners of the internet.
- A new study says it broke into mainstream awareness through a mix of **manufactured controversy**, **short-form video clips**, and pickup by **mainstream media outlets**.
- Researchers argue the jump wasn't purely algorithmic -- it followed a more deliberate, coordinated path from niche forums to the mainstream.

The Debate Starter

- Ask listeners: have you noticed 'looksmaxxing' content creeping into your feed, and did you ever wonder how it got there?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/study-outlines-the-five-stage-pipeline-clavicular-used-to-spread-diagnostic-masculinity-and-looksmaxxing/

■ *Cut the cameras: Flock surveillance cameras spur rare bipartisan backlash*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Bipartisan backlash against surveillance cameras is a rare 'left and right agree' framing that cuts through political fatigue and tends to travel well outside its original subreddit.

The Angle: *Flock's license-plate-reading cameras have quietly gone up in neighborhoods across the country, and now both privacy-minded conservatives and civil-liberties progressives are teaming up to fight back - a genuine bipartisan moment that's rare enough to be the story itself.*

- **Flock Safety** cameras track license plates in communities nationwide, and pushback is building from both sides of the aisle
- The backlash is described as **rare bipartisan** opposition - privacy hawks on the right and civil-liberties advocates on the left rallying around the same complaint
- Debate centers on surveillance overreach: who's watching the cameras, who has access to the data, and why

The Debate Starter

- Would you want a camera reading your license plate every time you drive through your own neighborhood - and does it change your answer knowing both parties are suddenly worried about it too?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2026/sep/05/flock-cameras-political-backlash

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *22-year-old Kaysville woman with Down syndrome becomes certified fitness instructor*

The Angle: *It's the kind of feel-good, against-the-odds story that makes for an easy, uplifting break in the show — representation in the fitness industry is still rare, and this one's got a hometown, human face to it.*

- A **22-year-old woman from Kaysville, Utah** has officially become a **certified fitness instructor**
- She has **Down syndrome** — a group historically underrepresented in the fitness/wellness industry
- Story originated out of **r/upliftingnews**, flagged specifically as a good-news moment

The Feel-Good Moment

- Ask listeners: who's the most unexpected person that ever became your gym motivation?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ksl.com/article/51620257/22-year-old-kaysville-woman-with-down-syndrome-becomes-certified-fitness-instructor

Backup options:

■ *'Rapunzel Syndrome': 16-year-old girl presented to emergency department with vomiting. CT scan revealed a hairball blocking stomach and small intestine requiring surgery. She started pulling her hair out and consuming it two years ago. But only about once a week, pulling only three hairs at a time.*

The Angle: *It sounds like an urban legend, but 'Rapunzel Syndrome' is a real (and rare) medical case that's basically tailor-made for a 'wait, WHAT' reaction on air — a slow-motion habit nobody noticed until it became an emergency.*

- A **16-year-old girl** went to the ER with vomiting
- A **CT scan** found a hairball blocking her stomach and small intestine
- She needed **surgery** to remove it
- She'd been pulling and eating her hair for **two years** — but only about **three hairs, once a week**

The Gross-Out Debate

- What's the weirdest 'small habit' you've heard of that turned out to be a hidden red flag?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/extremely-rare-rapunzel-syndrome-can-cause-a-hairball-so-large-it-requires-surgery

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■■ *Modelling projects drylands will cover about 40% of all land on Earth by 2100 under a high emissions path, as CO2 changes how much water plants and soil release.*

The Angle: *New modelling says rising CO2 is messing with how plants and soil hold water, and it could turn nearly 40% of Earth's land into drylands by century's end - a huge livability story people are already talking about online.*

- New modelling projects **drylands** could cover about **40% of all land on Earth by 2100** under a high-emissions scenario
- The driver isn't just heat - it's **CO2** changing how much water **plants and soil release** back into the air
- The study is generating buzz on **Reddit's r/science**

The Reality Check

- If almost half the planet could turn to desert, does that change how you think about where you'll retire?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://iopscience.iop.org/article/10.1088/1748-9326/ae9b29

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Chainsaw maker STIHL chief calls for longer hours without extra pay*

The Angle: *The head of chainsaw giant STIHL is publicly pushing for longer work hours with no extra pay, which is basically a corporate mic-drop on every "hustle culture" debate going right now.*

- **STIHL's** chief exec is calling for employees to work **longer hours** without additional pay
- Story's blowing up on **r/nottheonion** — the internet's designated home for headlines that sound fake but aren't
- Classic case of a CEO saying the quiet part loud about corporate expectations vs. paychecks

The Debate Starter

- Would you work extra hours for free if your boss just "asked nicely" — call in and tell us where you'd draw the line.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.euronews.com/business/2026/09/06/reforms-chainsaw-maker-stihl-chief-calls-for-longer-hours-without-extra-pay

Backup options:

■ *Ukraine Weighs Taxing OnlyFans Porn to Fund Drones and Defense*

The Angle: *Ukraine Weighs Taxing OnlyFans Porn to Fund Drones and Defense*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://clashreport.com/world/articles/ukraine-weighs-taxing-onlyfans-porn-to-fund-drones-and-defense-d9rrna1wp8w

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FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/4 this month; TECH TALK 1/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■■ *Art Collector bids $4,000 on broken vacuum cleaner only to discover it was trash*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate modern-art punchline — someone with money and a trained eye still couldn't tell a masterpiece from a busted Dyson, and that's a debate that writes itself for two hosts.*

- An **art collector** placed a winning bid of **$4,000** thinking they were buying a piece of art.
- The "piece" turned out to be a **broken vacuum cleaner**.
- Turns out it wasn't art at all — just **trash** that somehow ended up in the lot.

The Debate Starter

- Be honest — could you actually tell the difference between a $4,000 art installation and a broken vacuum?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Art or Trash?** - 60-second live game -> Producer describes a random household object (broken blender, pile of cables, dented lamp) and hosts have to guess 'gallery piece' or 'literal garbage' before the reveal.
- **Step 2: The Reveal** - Payoff beat -> Read off how many they got wrong and riff on how easy it'd be to get scammed at an art auction.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://artinc.co/art-collector-bids-4000-on-broken-vacuum-cleaner-only-to-discover-it-was-trash/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Patient Who Received Pig Kidney Becomes First To Progress to Human Kidney Transplant*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Pig-to-human kidney xenotransplant progressing to an actual human-donor transplant is a genuine medical milestone with 'first ever' framing that science press loves to amplify.
The Angle: *This is the feel-good medical headline of the year — a patient who survived on a pig kidney transplant just became the first to graduate to a human kidney, proof that the wild animal-organ experiments are actually buying people real time.*

- The patient originally received a **pig kidney transplant** as part of ongoing xenotransplantation trials.
- They're now the **first patient** to progress from that pig kidney to a full **human kidney transplant**.
- It's being framed as a milestone moment for the future of organ transplant medicine.

The Feel-Good Wrap

- Pig organs buying humans time until a real match shows up — science-fiction stuff that's actually working.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://hms.harvard.edu/news/patient-who-received-pig-kidney-becomes-first-progress-human-kidney-transplant

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■ *An arthritis drug has helped people with severe alopecia grow back all their scalp hair in two large Phase 3 trials, with up to 22.5% of patients getting all their hair back after 24 weeks. More than half on the highest dose regained at least 80% of their scalp hair.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A drug that fully regrows scalp hair in alopecia patients has a massive built-in emotional audience (alopecia has had high public visibility via celebrities) and a concrete, shareable stat (22.5% total regrowth).
The Angle: *Alopecia has been the condition modern medicine basically shrugged at — this is one of the first drugs to show it can straight-up reverse it in a major clinical trial, which is huge for the millions living with it.*

- The drug comes from the **arthritis medication** world, not a hair-specific treatment.
- Two large **Phase 3 trials** tested it on people with severe alopecia.
- Up to **22.5% of patients** grew back **all** their scalp hair after **24 weeks**.
- On the **highest dose**, more than **half** of patients regained at least **80%** of their scalp hair.

The Feel-Good Finish

- If you know someone living with alopecia, this is the kind of headline that makes their whole year.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/arthritis-drug-restores-up-to-100-of-hair-in-patients-with-severe-alopecia

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■ *At Telluride Film Festival, Bill Gates Compares Lack of Control Over AI to HAL in ‘2001’: ‘You Could Say “Please Shut Down,” and It Would Say, “OK, I Took That Under Advisement, But…”‘*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A named tech titan (Bill Gates) delivering a quotable, meme-ready HAL-9000 comparison about AI risk is exactly the kind of soundbite that gets clipped and recirculated.
The Angle: *Bill Gates showed up at Telluride comparing today's AI to the killer computer from '2001: A Space Odyssey' — and warned we already can't fully control it. It's a billionaire tech icon dropping a genuinely unsettling sci-fi comparison at a film festival, which is exactly the kind of quote that goes viral.*

- **Bill Gates** made the comparison at the **Telluride Film Festival**
- He referenced **HAL 9000** from **'2001: A Space Odyssey'**, imagining telling an AI to shut down and it replying: **"OK, I took that under advisement, but..."**
- Gates also compared AI to a classic alien-invasion movie plot, saying **"the aliens are here"** — a **"foreign intelligence with a different set of motivations we can't even understand"**
- He noted that in those old alien movies, governments banded together to face the threat — implying we're not doing that with AI

The Debate Starter

- Is Bill Gates being dramatic for a movie-festival crowd, or is 'we can't turn it off' the scariest sentence in tech right now?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/bill-gates-ai-controls-telluride-film-festival-2001-1236853326/

■ *Bad Bunny Makes Historic Hops with Seven Emmy Wins for Super Bowl Halftime Show; Other Musicians Hit High Notes (And Some Misses)*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Bad Bunny setting a historic Emmy record for the Super Bowl Halftime Show combines a top-tier global name with a clean, quantifiable superlative that's easy to headline.
The Angle: *Seven Emmy wins for one Super Bowl halftime show is a massive haul — it's a good excuse to talk about how the halftime show has become its own award-season battleground, not just a football sideshow.*

- **Bad Bunny's** Super Bowl Halftime Show reportedly took home **seven Emmy wins** — a historic total for the category.
- The Emmys also recognized other musicians' TV moments this cycle, with a mix of wins and notable misses.

The Debate Starter

- Is the halftime show now a bigger award-season event than the actual Grammys performance slot?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/09/bad-bunny-makes-history-seven-emmy-wins-super-bowl-halftime-1237069638/

■ *Box Office: ‘Spider-Man: Brand New Day’ Remains No. 1 in Sixth Weekend, Nears ‘Avengers: Endgame’ All-Time Domestic Record*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A specific, chaseable box-office record (nearing Avengers: Endgame) tied to Spider-Man gives this concrete stakes and a built-in update cycle as it climbs.
The Angle: *A superhero movie holding the top spot for six straight weekends is rare air, and now it's within striking distance of Endgame's all-time domestic crown — that's a real pop-culture milestone worth a mention.*

- **Spider-Man: Brand New Day** has held the **No. 1 spot** for a **sixth straight weekend** at the box office
- It's now closing in on **Avengers: Endgame's** all-time domestic box office record
- A sixth weekend at No. 1 is an unusually long run for any movie, let alone a superhero sequel

The Debate Starter

- Does Spidey actually catch Endgame, or does it fall just short of the record books?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/box-office/spiderman-brand-new-day-box-office-sixth-weekend-1236852435/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 11 banked (+15 each when found)
- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she’s sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)

- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt ‘Disappointed’ by BLACKPINK’s 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
- "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite’s ‘Override’ Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary ‘B’Day’ Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "‘A modern Dickie Dee bike’: Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)

Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-06 11:50 PM